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Table of Contents

Project Title 4

Literature Review 4

1. Introduction 4

2. Overview of Cybersecurity in Malta 5

2.1 National Cybersecurity in Malta 5

2.2 Regulatory Landscape 5

3. Cyber Threats in Malta 6

3.1 Common Cyber Threats 6

3.2 Vulnerabilities 7

4. Risk Factors 8

4.1 Risk factors for Individuals 8

4.2 Risk factors for Businesses 9

5. Prevention of Strategies 10

5.1 For Individuals 10

5.2 For Businesses 12

5.3 National-level Initiatives 12

6. Cybersecurity Training Requirements: Handling Malta's Threats 13

6.1 Specific Training Needs in Cybersecurity 13

6.2 Advantages of Providing Cybersecurity Training 14

7. Gaps in Current Research 15

8. Conclusion 15

References 16

Project Title*: *Cyber Threats in Malta: Analysing Vulnerabilities, Risk Factors, and Prevention Strategies for Individuals and Businesses.

Literature Review

1. Introduction

Due to the increasing risks that individuals and businesses face from cyberattacks, cybersecurity has received a lot of attention in Malta in recent years. The country's rapid digital transformation and growing reliance on internet services have raised the risk of cyberattacks, revealing flaws in several sectors. Malta's strategic location in the Mediterranean and the expansion of its banking, gaming and blockchain industries make it a popular target for hackers. Malta, sometimes referred to as "The Blockchain Island," has put in place a strong legal framework for distributed ledger technologies (DLTs) and cryptocurrency enterprises. One such law is the Virtual Financial Assets Act (VFAA), which governs ICOs and cryptocurrency exchanges (James Debono, 2023) (PWC, 2023). Although these advancements increase Malta's attractiveness as a worldwide blockchain centre, they also give cybercriminals new ways to target high-value industries (Chetcuti Cauchi, 2018). Thus, it is essential to understand Malta's unique cybersecurity environment, identify risk indicators, and implement robust preventative measures to safeguard the country's digital assets and provide resilience in a world that is becoming more interconnected by the day.

Particularly in vital industries like public administration, iGaming, and financial services, the significance of cybersecurity has grown dramatically. The necessity for secure online platforms to safeguard sensitive data and uphold client trust has increased as a result of the financial sector's shift towards digital banking and fintech innovation. In a similar vein, Malta's thriving iGaming sector, which is among the biggest in Europe, depends heavily on safe and dependable digital infrastructures to guard against fraud and data breaches, which can have serious negative effects on reputation and regulations. Additionally, digitalisation in public administration seeks to increase efficiency and accessibility, but it also necessitates strong cybersecurity safeguards to protect citizen data and guarantee the continuation of critical services. When taken as a whole, these industries highlight the urgent need for strong cybersecurity measures to counter emerging threats brought on by technological breakthroughs and preserve Malta's standing as a reliable and robust digital centre.

Malta’s strategic location in the Mediterranean, along with its growing reputation as a hub for international business, makes it an appealing target for cybercriminals. The country attracts a high volume of digital traffic, particularly in sectors like financial services and iGaming, which handle substantial amounts of sensitive data. As a result, cybercriminals see Malta as a lucrative target, with cyberattacks threatening not only local businesses but also Malta's international standing as a secure digital economy (Cutajar, 2024).

In order to protect people and businesses in Malta, it is essential to analyse vulnerabilities, risk factors, and preventative measures. With assaults ranging from ransomware to data breaches, cyber threats are

becoming more widespread and sophisticated, impacting financial assets, vital infrastructure, and personal data. Understanding these risks is crucial for organisations, especially those in industries like finance and iGaming, to maintain operational continuity, comply with regulations, and manage their reputations. For individuals, it helps safeguard personal information and online privacy. Malta can improve its capacity to anticipate and lessen cyberthreats by analysing risk factors and vulnerabilities. This will help the country create robust prevention policies that safeguard digital assets and guarantee confidence in the digital ecosystem.

2. Overview of Cybersecurity in Malta

2.1 National Cybersecurity in Malta

The four primary areas of focus for Malta's National Cybersecurity Strategy (2023–2026) are designed to promote a safe and robust digital environment:

- ***Cybersecurity Governance Capacity:*** Strengthening laws, rules, policies, and best practices to create a comprehensive governance framework. This area emphasizes the development of a resilient legal and regulatory structure that can adapt to new cyber threats, ensuring compliance and resilience across sectors.

- ***Cyber Defence Capacity:*** Prioritizing the protection of Malta's critical infrastructure, including government operations, telecommunications, and financial services. This domain focuses on implementing proactive defenses and response systems to safeguard national cyber assets from potential attacks.

- ***Cyber Competence and Culture:*** Fostering a proactive security culture by enhancing cybersecurity knowledge and skills in both the public and private sectors. This includes awareness initiatives, skill-building projects, and training programs to empower individuals and organizations to identify and manage cyber threats effectively.

- ***International Cooperation:*** Emphasizing the importance of sharing information, intelligence, and best practices with partners in Europe and globally. By aligning with the NIS2 Directive, Malta facilitates coordinated responses to cybersecurity threats through collaborative threat intelligence and expertise sharing with other EU member states (Maltese National Cybersecurity, 2021).

2.2 Regulatory Landscape

Malta's cybersecurity strategy closely complies with EU laws that strengthen cybersecurity and data protection across industries.

- ***GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation):*** Enacted in 2018, the GDPR places stringent restrictions on how companies gather, process, store, and share personal data in order to safeguard it throughout the EU. GDPR requires Maltese businesses to implement thorough data protection procedures in order to respect people's rights, including the ability to view, update, and remove personal information. Businesses must strengthen cybersecurity procedures to prevent data breaches because non-compliance can result in significant fines. By requiring data security protocols, this rule not only protects the privacy of individuals but also improves the operational security of organisations (The European Data Protection Regulation, 2016).

- ***The Network and Information Systems Directive, or NIS Directive:*** In order to improve cybersecurity throughout the EU, the NIS Directive requires vital service providers and digital service providers to report security incidents. It encompasses industries including energy, finance, health, and telecommunications in Malta and calls on businesses to control risks, stop accidents, and notify national authorities of noteworthy occurrences. The directive strengthens operational security and promotes resilience against cyber threats by emphasising the protection of essential infrastructure (Nist, 2024).

- ***DORA (Digital Operational Resilience Act):*** The DORA framework is intended to improve financial institutions' ability to withstand cyberattacks. DORA requires incident reporting, resilience testing, and ICT risk management for banks, insurers, and investment institutions. In order to protect customer data and uphold industry trust, DORA in Malta makes sure financial institutions are prepared to endure and bounce back from cyber disruptions. DORA enhances cybersecurity in the financial sector and fosters a safe environment for online transactions by establishing resilience criteria (THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT, 2016).

Together, these laws protect individual data rights and place strict security requirements on companies, thereby influencing Malta's cybersecurity environment. In order to safeguard both individual privacy and corporate resilience against changing cyberthreats, they mandate that organisations implement improved cybersecurity policies.

3. Cyber Threats in Malta

3.1 Common Cyber Threats

In 2024, the following 10 cyberthreats will most likely impact Maltese individuals and businesses: (SentinelOne, 2024) (Medlock, 2024)

1. ***Phishing Attacks:*** These attacks are still very common, and they use increasingly individualised and AI-powered strategies to fool consumers into disclosing private information.

2. ***Ransomware:*** Cybercriminals use ransomware attacks to target organisations, encrypting data and requesting payment to unlock it. This type of assault particularly affects industries that depend on vital data.

3. ***Social Engineering:*** Social engineering techniques, including posing as reliable sources, take advantage of human psychology and can be dangerous even in extremely safe settings.

4. ***Insider Threats:*** Serious breaches may result from disgruntled workers or careless insiders exposing private data or infecting systems with malware.

5. ***IoT Vulnerabilities:*** As more IoT devices are used, insecure IoT networks are targeted by hackers, which can result in data theft or device takeovers for more extensive cyberattacks.

6. ***Supply Chain Attacks:*** Attackers use third-party providers to gain access to networks, highlighting the importance of stringent vendor control and security due diligence.

7. ***Denial-of-Service (DoS) Attacks:*** Attackers overload systems with traffic in an attempt to interfere with services, which can impact company operations and result in losses.

8. ***Exploitation of Artificial Intelligence (AI):*** Cybercriminals employ AI to detect system vulnerabilities and craft sophisticated phishing messages, making attacks more difficult to detect.

9. ***DNS Tunneling:*** By evading conventional security protections and concealing malicious data within DNS traffic, this approach enables attackers to create command-and-control channels or exfiltrate data.

10. ***State-Sponsored Attacks:*** To gain political leverage or espionage, nation-state actors frequently target vital infrastructure, including finance and telecommunications, underscoring the necessity of strong national cybersecurity policies. (SentinelOne, 2024) (Medlock, 2024)

3.2 Vulnerabilities

The growing frequency of cyberattacks in Malta draws attention to particular weaknesses in both personal and corporate environments. Developing successful preventative efforts requires an understanding of these vulnerabilities (Gov, 2024).

Lack of Awareness

The general lack of cybersecurity knowledge and training among Maltese people and small enterprises is a serious danger. Many employees and business owners are easy targets for attackers because they don't know how to spot phishing attempts or social engineering techniques. Because of this ignorance, an organization's security chain has weak spots that hackers can use as a point of access. Implementing frequent training sessions on cybersecurity best practices, particularly for staff members in frontline roles, could help address this vulnerability by assisting them in identifying and reporting suspicious activity (Gov, 2024).

Outdated Systems

Many Maltese businesses, especially smaller ones, depend on antiquated systems that are frequently challenging to repair or modernise. These systems are more susceptible to cyberattacks since they might not have the required patches or updates. Upgrading these systems can sometimes be prohibitively expensive and disruptive to operations, which increases the possibility that attackers will take advantage of them. For example, security fixes may no longer be available for older operating systems, leaving them vulnerable to known vulnerabilities.

To reduce this risk, a well-rounded strategy is needed. To restrict access to critical data on obsolete systems, organisations could implement compensating controls such network segmentation. Finding important areas that require immediate attention might also be aided by routine vulnerability assessments. Long-term financial and operational limitations related to maintaining antiquated systems may be lessened by allocating funds for incremental system improvements and making investments in adaptable infrastructure options, such as cloud services (Gov, 2024).

Inadequate Security Measures

Inadequate cybersecurity frameworks are frequently the result of smaller Maltese firms' resource limitations. These organisations might not have access to essential defences like firewalls, intrusion detection systems, and multifactor authentication if they lack the resources or staff needed to put in place thorough security procedures. Examples from the real world demonstrate this vulnerability: for example, ransomware and data breaches frequently affect small enterprises with inadequate security, as attackers target their weaker defences.

Adopting a prioritised strategy and concentrating initially on the most important controls—like installing basic firewalls, antivirus software, and regular backup procedures—is a practical way to improve security in situations with limited resources. Smaller businesses could modify cybersecurity frameworks like ISO 27001 or the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) to suit their security requirements within their financial constraints. It is still true that hackers would try to compromise any target, and the most vulnerable are the ones with the lowest defences (Gov, 2024).

4. Risk Factors

4.1 Risk factors for Individuals

1. ***Password Management:*** A lot of people continue to use weak or recurring passwords on many sites, which leaves them vulnerable to attacks such as credential stuffing and illegal access. Securing personal accounts requires strong password practices, such as creating complicated and one-of-a-kind passwords (IEEE, 2012)

2. ***Phishing Susceptibility:*** Users who are not aware of phishing techniques are at risk of being attacked. Phishing is still one of the most popular techniques used by cybercriminals to trick people into divulging private information.

3. ***Social Media Exposure:*** People who share too much personal information online run the risk of being the victim of social engineering and identity theft. Cybercriminals can launch targeted assaults by obtaining personal information from social media networks.
4. ***Lack of Cybersecurity Awareness and Training:*** People are unable to identify different kinds of cyberthreats if they are not properly trained. Reducing the dangers associated with human error requires educating the public about cybersecurity best practices.

5. ***Use of Unsecured Networks:*** Using public Wi-Fi networks puts you at risk because hackers can capture data and communications. Protecting private data on public networks requires the use of secure networks or a Virtual Private Network (VPN).

6. ***Device Management and Software Updates:*** Patching security flaws requires regular software updates. People may become vulnerable to known exploits if their gadgets and apps are not updated.

7. ***Privacy and Security Settings:*** Inadvertently exposing sensitive data might result from improperly setup privacy settings on devices and apps. The secret to safeguarding personal data online is making sure privacy settings are configured correctly.

8. ***Poor Backup Procedures:*** In the case of a ransomware attack or other security catastrophe, people run the danger of suffering a major loss of data if they don't regularly backup their data. Frequent backups can lessen the impact of these kinds of attacks.

4.2 Risk factors for Businesses

Numerous risk variables that businesses must deal with can make them more susceptible to cyberattacks. Some of the major concerns are highlighted by the following points:

1. ***Third-party Risks:*** A lot of companies nowadays depend significantly on outside suppliers and service providers, which frequently present security issues. Vendors may range in their cybersecurity maturity, and if these third parties are compromised, the company may be at risk for financial losses, reputational harm, and data breaches. Supply chain assaults have grown to be a major worry as cybercriminals target third parties with lax security measures in order to access larger networks. Such attacks are becoming more frequent as hackers take advantage of weaknesses in less secure third parties to gain access to larger organisations, according to the European Union Agency for Cybersecurity (Enisa, 2023). To reduce these risks, businesses must integrate strong vendor management procedures and conduct a thorough assessment of the

security standards of their third-party partners. This entails conducting frequent security audits, establishing explicit cybersecurity standards for suppliers, and exchanging data via safe means.

2. ***Insufficient Employee Training:*** The absence of thorough and continuous cybersecurity training for staff members is one of the biggest risk concerns for companies. Employees might not be aware of such risks like ransomware attacks, social engineering techniques, phishing emails, or inappropriate data handling if they are not properly trained. Because employees are usually the weakest link in the security chain, cybercriminals frequently take advantage of human error. Effective staff training is essential for reducing human error in cybersecurity, claims unsecure (2024). Frequent and thorough training can greatly lower the risk that staff members will become victims of ransomware, phishing scams, and other frequent dangers. Companies should use tactics like simulated phishing exercises, continual training, and continuous awareness campaigns to make sure staff members are aware of changing risks and prepared to respond to them. Businesses can lower the chance of successful assaults by offering frequent training and awareness campaigns. The most recent threat trends, safe data practices, and how to recognise any phishing attempts or other malicious activity should all be included in this instruction.

3. ***Complex IT Infrastructure:*** Businesses are more vulnerable to cyberattacks as a result of their increasing reliance on digital technology, particularly in industries like financial services and critical infrastructure. The attack surface grows as businesses implement increasingly sophisticated IT infrastructures, such as cloud computing, Internet of Things (IoT) devices, and network connectivity, making it more challenging to safeguard every endpoint. This is particularly noticeable in Malta's vital infrastructure sectors, like electricity, healthcare, and transportation, where inadequate system protection can have serious repercussions. In order to protect these vital systems, the National Cybersecurity Strategy of Malta (2023) highlights the necessity of a comprehensive approach to cybersecurity, stressing the significance of combining technology solutions with staff knowledge. Strong cybersecurity procedures that are regularly updated to address new threats are essential because the interconnectedness of different systems and devices might make them more susceptible to coordinated cyberattacks. In these situations, a proactive security and crisis management culture is just as important as technological solutions for effective risk management.

Businesses must concentrate on these risk elements, especially staff training, third-party risks, and the complexity of contemporary IT infrastructures, in order to lessen the increasing cyberthreats they encounter. A company's ability to withstand assaults can be greatly increased by creating a thorough cybersecurity plan that takes these factors into account.

5. Prevention of Strategies

5.1 For Individuals

By putting important cybersecurity procedures into practice, people and organisations can improve their defences against online attacks. These tactics, which range from technical protections to awareness campaigns, are meant to lessen vulnerabilities and increase resilience in a world that is becoming more and more digital.

1. Awareness Campaigns: A key element of successful cybersecurity programs are national awareness campaigns, which disseminate crucial cyber hygiene information and encourage best practices among the populace (Enisa, 2023).
2. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): Studies reveal that 99.9% of account compromise attempts can be prevented by putting MFA into place (microsoft, N/A). According to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (Nist, 2024), MFA is especially effective at safeguarding sensitive accounts by including an extra layer of security on top of the conventional password.

3. Regular Software Updates: To guard against cyber vulnerabilities that attackers could exploit, make sure devices and apps have the most recent security updates installed.

4. Strong and Unique Passwords: Research indicates that creating strong, one-of-a-kind passwords for every account reduces the possibility of breaches brought on by credential stuffing or password reuse (Enisa, 2023).

5. Use of Antivirus and Anti-Malware Software: Setting up trustworthy antivirus software helps avoid ransomware, malware, and other harmful attacks early on.

6. Educating About Phishing and Social Engineering: It has been shown that being aware of phishing and other social engineering techniques greatly lowers vulnerability to these types of assaults (KnowBe4, 2024)

7. Data Encryption: In order to avoid unwanted access in the event of loss or theft, data encryption is a highly advised practice, particularly for sensitive information kept on mobile devices (Nist, 2024).

8. Backup and Data Recovery Plans: To ensure data availability and lessen the effects of ransomware attacks, regular data backups are crucial (Enisa, 2023).

9. Safe Browsing Practices: Being cautious when browsing, like avoiding dubious links and giving preference to safe websites (HTTPS), will greatly lower the chance of running into malware.

10. Secure Wi-Fi Networks: To prevent unwanted network access, use strong passwords and stay off public Wi-Fi when doing sensitive transactions (Nist, 2024).

11. Restrict Personal Information Sharing: Reducing the amount of personal information shared on social media can lower the danger of social engineering and identity theft (Enisa, 2023).

12. Privacy Settings Management: Users can regulate the exposure of personal information and lower cyber threats by managing privacy settings on social media platforms.

13. Incident Response Awareness: In order to minimise any damages as soon as possible in the event of suspected cyberattacks, people must be aware of incident response procedures.

5.2 For Businesses

Businesses are confronted with increasing cyberthreats in today's digital environment, which have the potential to corrupt data and cause operational disruptions. Organisations must use proactive measures to mitigate these risks, such as frequent risk assessments, staff training, cutting-edge security tools, and efficient incident response plans. When taken as a whole, these steps assist companies in enhancing cybersecurity, lowering vulnerabilities, and enhancing resistance to changing cyberattacks.

Risk assessments: Businesses can find weaknesses in their infrastructure by conducting regular cybersecurity risk assessments. Organisations can lower the chance of incidents and guarantee regulatory compliance by identifying vulnerabilities and prioritising security solutions that address important risks (FFIEC, 2016) (Homeland Security, n.d.).

Programs for Employee Training: Constant training enables staff members to identify and handle risks such as ransomware and phishing. Frequent updates and simulations aid in keeping watch, lowering human mistake as a typical port of entry for cyberattacks. (FFIEC, 2016) (Homeland Security, n.d.).

AI-driven Advanced Security Solutions: AI-driven solutions, like Darktrace, track network traffic to spot irregularities instantly, spotting and addressing possible risks before they become more serious. By offering automated reactions to complex threats, these adaptive systems improve security. (FFIEC, 2016)

Incident Response Plans: Businesses can minimise harm by quickly containing and recovering from cyber incidents when they have a well-defined incident response plan. These strategies, which are tested and updated frequently, guarantee a coordinated, efficient response to a range of threat situations (Homeland Security, n.d.).

When combined, these tactics provide a strong defence against online attacks for companies.

5.3 National-level Initiatives

The Maltese government has made significant strides in improving cybersecurity resilience across sectors. Key initiatives include:

Programs for Cybersecurity Education and Training: The government has made developing cybersecurity proficiency a top priority by offering a range of courses and trainings to the public and professionals. The development of a culture that is resilient to cyberthreats depends heavily on these initiatives. Initiatives such as CyberWiser (https://cyberwiser.eu/malta-mt) provide specialised instruction and materials to improve cybersecurity knowledge and proficiency across the board.

International Cooperation: To make sure that regional plans are in line with international best practices, Malta actively cooperates with international organisations like ENISA (European Union Agency for Cybersecurity). This kind of cooperation improves Malta's national cybersecurity posture and keeps it abreast of new developments in the field. For instance, in order to improve national defence against cyber threats, Malta's National Cybersecurity Strategy (https://economy.gov.mt/uncategorized/national-cybersecurity-strategy/) leverages the knowledge of ENISA and other international partners.

These efforts are essential to making sure Malta is resilient against the increasing number of national and international cyberthreats.

6. *Cybersecurity Training Requirements: Handling Malta's Threats*

Malta's economy is rapidly going digital, which has made cybersecurity a top concern. The nation is more vulnerable to cyberattacks as sectors like banking, healthcare, and tourism embrace cutting-edge technologies. Effective cyber risk mitigation necessitates specialised training, as shown by an analysis of vulnerabilities, risk factors, and prevention techniques.

6.1 Specific Training Needs in Cybersecurity

I. ***Awareness and Fundamental Cyber Hygiene:*** Up to 80% of cyber events can be avoided with training on spotting dangerous software, managing secure passwords, and spotting phishing efforts (Festus Ndubuisi Nkwo, n.d.). Every person and organisation needs fundamental abilities because of Malta's growing connectedness.

II. ***Threat management and incident response:*** It's critical to give experts the tools they need to recognise, address, and eliminate dangers. Research indicates that companies with a strong incident response team save 55% on the costs associated with data breaches. (Noor Hazlina Abdul Mutalib, 2024).

III. ***Sector-Specific Training:*** Because of the sensitivity of their data, sectors including healthcare and financial services need specialised cybersecurity procedures. Malta needs

extensive training in encryption, compliance requirements (such GDPR), and secure infrastructure procedures because of its heavy reliance on these industries.

IV. ***Advanced Threat Detection:*** The use of AI by hackers to create complex assaults has made specialised training in threat hunting and machine learning-based detection systems more and more important. Deepfakes and customised messaging are two AI-powered strategies that have contributed to a 28% increase in phishing attempts in 2024. Multi-channel assaults that take advantage of less secure channels, such as those using email, SMS, and collaborative platforms, have increased in frequency. Attackers can improve and automate phishing tactics with AI, which makes them more difficult to identify and greatly increases their success rates. These patterns highlight the pressing need for cutting-edge cybersecurity protections. (Udinmwen, 2024)

V. ***Policy and Governance Training:*** Executives and policymakers need to be aware of how cybersecurity affects legal frameworks and business continuity more broadly. Governance education guarantees adherence to EU regulations and the application of risk assessment procedures.

6.2 Advantages of Providing Cybersecurity Training

I. ***Enhanced Security Posture:*** Cybersecurity Ventures emphasises that people are frequently the first line of defence, and that training has a significant impact on lowering breaches. Regular training and human awareness greatly reduce the risk of phishing and other assaults. (Hyperproof Team, 2024)

II. Economic Protection: The economic significance of cyber disasters is highlighted by the fact that the average cost of a data breach worldwide in 2024 increased to $4.88 million. Reducing these threats safeguards important economic sectors for areas like Malta that depend on digital industry. (Finio & Downie, 2024)

III. ***Enhanced Worker Productivity:*** Trained staff members are more capable of managing risks, which lowers downtime and interruptions brought on by cyberattacks. This enhances overall effectiveness and fortitude in the face of cybersecurity threats. (Brecht, 2019)

IV. Compliance and Reputation Management: By helping companies comply with standards like GDPR and others, training helps them stay out of trouble and build stakeholder trust. Additionally, a robust security architecture guards against harm

to one's reputation, which is essential for preserving a company's credibility over the long run. (Brecht, 2019) (Finio & Downie, 2024)

7. Gaps in Current Research

While considerable research has been conducted on cybersecurity in Malta, several notable gaps remain that hinder a comprehensive understanding of the nation's cybersecurity landscape:

Limited Focus on SMEs: Despite the critical role that Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) play in the Maltese economy, there is a lack of dedicated studies examining their specific cybersecurity challenges and needs. SMEs often face unique vulnerabilities due to limited resources and cybersecurity expertise, yet little research has explored how these businesses are managing cyber threats or the specific barriers they face in implementing effective cybersecurity measures (The Malta Business Weekly, 2024) (Writer, 2023).

Absence of Comprehensive Data on Prevention Effectiveness: Another significant gap is the lack of robust, sector-specific data on the effectiveness of current cybersecurity prevention strategies in Malta. While various cybersecurity measures have been implemented across industries, there is limited research evaluating how these strategies reduce cyber incidents. Understanding the efficacy of existing measures would be crucial in shaping future policies and practices to enhance the national cybersecurity posture (Writer, 2023)

These gaps highlight important areas where further research could provide valuable insights, particularly in understanding the unique needs of SMEs and assessing the real-world impact of current cybersecurity initiatives. Addressing these issues would contribute to improving the overall resilience of Malta's cybersecurity framework.

8. Conclusion

In summary, this literature review highlights the evolving nature of cyber threats, which pose significant risks to both individuals and businesses in Malta. The increasing sophistication of cyberattacks requires continuous adaptation to ensure effective protection. While national strategies and regulations are being implemented to address these challenges, there remains a pressing need for greater awareness, enhanced regulatory compliance, and the adoption of more advanced technological solutions to fortify Malta's cybersecurity landscape.

Ultimately, continued research into vulnerabilities, risk factors, and prevention strategies is essential to keep pace with emerging threats. By addressing current gaps in the understanding of cybersecurity challenges, particularly those faced by SMEs and the real-world effectiveness of existing measures, Malta can strengthen its resilience against cyber threats and improve its overall cybersecurity posture.

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